Policy

Assessments

Purpose

A requirement of the Joint Accreditation System of Australia & New Zealand (JASANZ) under which the Quality and Safety Program (QSPP) is accredited is to use an allocation model for assessments. To achieve this, QSPP has partnered with Ernst and Young (EY). Assessments are conducted by QSPP endorsed assessors that have been drawn from EY's specialist audit practice. This policy describes principles guiding the administration of QSPP assessments.

1. Application

EY will allocate a QSPP endorsed assessor to conduct a QSPP assessment. Assessment services are administered by EY, QSPP's assessment partner. EY will allocate a QSPP endorsed assessor based on the agreed assessment date and available assessor resources.

A pharmacy is not able to request a specific assessor. For pharmacies requesting an initial assessment it may take up to six months for an assessment date to become available.

1.1 Alternate assessor requests

Consistent with the QSPP Program Rules, where a real or perceived possibility of a conflict of interest ('conflict') has been confirmed, QSPP will assess the alleged conflict. If considered a conflict, QSPP will arrange for another QSPP endorsed assessor to conduct the assessment as per the QSPP assessor allocation process.

1.2 Witnessed assessments

Consistent with the Program Rules an additional attendee may be present at the time of assessment. This person is there to witness the assessment process and has no impact on the assessment outcome. Where reasonable, QSPP will provide advance notice of an additional attendee.

2. Cancelled assessments

2.1 Cancellation or changes less than 10 calendar days

Should an assessment date booking be changed or cancelled by a pharmacy owner or authorised delegate with less than 10 calendar days' notice, a pharmacy will:

1. forfeit their QSPP Assessment included as part of the QSPP Annual Fee, or
2. a cancellation fee equivalent to the current assessment fee (see schedule of fees), will be charged, and
3. any travel expenses incurred to date by the assessment company will be charged.

An assessment may also be cancelled at the discretion of QSPP where it is apparent that a pharmacy is not in a position to proceed with assessment e.g. at least one pharmacy owner not being present or lack of preparedness. In such instances points 1 to 3 above would also apply.

Where the cancellation policy applies, the pharmacy may be required to pay any outstanding invoice, prior to a new assessment date being booked.

A pharmacy may request this policy not be applied where exceptional circumstances exist, as outlined in the Exceptional Circumstances Policy.

Scenario	Result
Change requested due to exceptional circumstances	Assessment rebooked without charge.
Change requested due to reasons outside of pharmacy's control, but which are not exceptional circumstances	Assessment may be rebooked, subject to QSPP operational requirements, including assessor availability.
Change requested due to pharmacy not being ready for assessment	Assessment unable to be rebooked. Cancellation policy may apply.
Owner not present for onsite assessment	Assessment cancelled. Assessment may be rebooked, subject to QSPP operational requirements, including assessor availability. Cancellation fee will apply.

2.2 Cancellation or changes more than 10 calendar days

Should a pharmacy owner or authorised delegate request a change or cancellation of an assessment booking with greater than 10 calendar days' notice, an Accreditation Expiry Extension Request may be required where changes to assessment bookings result in the pharmacy being unable to complete all required assessment activities prior to their accreditation expiry date.

Requests for reschedules or extension of time will be assessed on their merits and the decision to grant the request is entirely at the discretion of the QSPP. Requests must be received prior to the pharmacy's existing accreditation expiry date. The request will only be granted in exceptional circumstances.

3. Re-assessments

A pharmacy may reasonably be required to undergo re-assessment as per QSPP Program Rules. Should a re-assessment be required, the pharmacy will incur the cost of the re-assessment. Pharmacies will be advised at the time of assessment the time frame in which non-conformances must be remediated.

The pharmacy's accreditation date will not change as a result of a re-assessment.

4. Additional Assessments

Program Rules describe circumstances in which additional assessments may be required.

5. Expansion of Services

Under the Program Rules a Pharmacy must notify QSPP of changes to the current professional services offered in the business. The Expansion of Pharmacy Services Assessment can provide provisional accreditation where additional pharmacy service(s) are commenced between reaccreditation assessments.

Expansion of Pharmacy Services Assessments are available to accredited pharmacies.

QSPP may refer a request for an Expansion of Services (EOS) Assessment to a full or partial assessment where:

- The pharmacy is expected to undertake a full or partial on-site or remote QSPP Assessment within the next three months,
- The pharmacy has requested three or more Expansion of Services Assessments within 3 months, or
- QSPP reasonably considers a more comprehensive assessment is necessary prior to accreditation of the service.

An Expansion of Services assessment will incur a fee which must be paid prior to any evidence being reviewed. The pharmacy has a maximum of thirty (30) days from payment of the invoice interim report to provide all evidence required for the accreditation of the expanded service level.

The accreditation of the service level is provisional until assessed via the next onsite QSPP assessment.

6. Appealable decisions

Assessment outcomes are appealable decisions, consistent with the Program Rules and the *Procedural Fairness and Impartiality Policy*.

Related documentation

Cancellation Policy
Procedural Fairness and Impartiality Policy
Program Rules
Sanctions Management Policy
Schedule of Fees
Terms and Conditions